

This is officially the 24th Digit Zero1 Awards, something we started in 2001 as a way to hero the best-performing products in multiple categories. We started this off back then in order to hero devices that were heavily R&D driven, that were pushing the boundaries of performance, because, let's face it, if we can afford it, all of us want to buy the absolute best of the best. The Digit Zero1 Awards was the challenge laid down to our Test Centre and to all of the hundreds of reviewers who have worked for us over the past 23 years... it was the end goal we all had in mind every time we tested a new product, and every time we added on a new product category to test. The Digit Zero1 Awards are the reason why Digit has the most comprehensive testing methodologies for the most product categories tested by a media house across the country! We have to test more thoroughly and more comprehensively, because at the very highest end of every product category, the difference between competing products can often narrow down to a sliver. At the high-performance end of the market, many other 'reviewers' will end up offering opinions instead of facts and rely on subjective scoring instead of objective testing because their test processes just aren't as detailed and rigorous as ours.

We do have one small problem with the annual schedule though, which is that we cannot consider products that are launched between November 15th and December 31st of a calendar year for that year's Zero1 Awards. Those products get considered for the next year's

awards instead, unless of course companies send us those products before launch, under embargo, which has happened quite a few times. There is also a slight difference between how we score all products. While normally the tested score you see in the magazine and on the website includes considerations of features and value for money along with performance, for the Zero1 Awards, we do not consider either features or value for money, because the awards are given to the Best Performing Products of the Year. The product that wins the Digit Zero1 Award in a category in 2023 will actually be held up as the defining product of that year, and it will be what we pit all products that come the next year against. For example, we will use the winner of the Digit Zero1 Award 2022 for Best Gaming Laptop to measure the performance increase of the 2024 winner, and thus know how far the industry has improved in sheer performance terms. As hard as we try, we may not be able to test all products launched in a category, we are human and need sleep, you know! For the Best Buy Award that accompanies the Zero1 Award, we do go back to considering value for money or performance-to-price ratios to ensure we arrive at which product is the "Best Buy" in a category for a given year. Sadly, since space in the magazine is limited, we can't carry the results of every category we test. You can find any that have been omitted from the magazine at: <https://www.digit.in/zero1-awards/>

Now let's dive straight into seeing how the gadgets we all love hold up against our tests! 

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